

Signal of the week

NHTSA opens 'Recalls Next' docket on OTA updates and automated vehicles

NHTSA published Federal Register notice 2026-19712 on 28 September opening docket NHTSA-2026-2014 and scheduling a 5 November meeting on how OTA updates, connected vehicles and automated vehicles affect recall completion. Public comments run until 5 December 2026.

Why it matters — First formal US rulemaking inquiry treating OTA and AV lifecycle as a recall-completion problem.

Sources: Federal Register / NHTSA (2026-09-28) · SDV Sector (2026-09-29)

Where the activity was

	SDV	Connect- ivity	AI	Data mgmt	Digital twins	Regu- latory	Cyber- security	Quality	Telematics services
Automotive	3	0	2	0	0	2	0	2	0
Robotics / AV	0	0	3	1	0	2	0	1	2
Fleets	1	1	0	2	0	1	1	0	1
Energy	0	2	1	1	0	1	0	1	1
Agri / industrial	1	0	1	0	1	1	1	0	0

Qualifying items this week (score ≥ 6), by theme: none 1-2 3-5 6+

The read-across

Regulators dominated the week. NHTSA opened a formal docket on OTA updates and automated vehicles complicating recall completion, UNECE's driverless ADS framework moved towards EU transposition, and EU Cyber Resilience Act reporting duties went live for aftermarket and off-highway equipment. Cyber themes are prominent where R155, CRA, and ISO/SAE 21434 overlap across automotive, fleets, and agriculture.

Connectivity and AI advanced together. Kigen became the first automotive eSIM certified against GSMA eSA for SGP.32 v1.3, Humax shipped a 22 kW fleet charger with embedded eSIM, and Applied Intuition extended its autonomy stack to Komatsu haul trucks.

75
candidates screened

14
items featured

4
deals logged

● Automotive OEMs

Regulatory AI SDV

NHTSA report confirms UNECE driverless ADS GTR adoption, UK and EU prepare transposition

NHTSA's September 2026 Report to Congress confirmed WP.29 adopted the first global driverless ADS regulation and GTR in June. The EU Commission's delegated regulation under the General Safety Regulation is expected in Q4 2026, with UK liability principles reaffirmed.

So what — First binding international framework for Level 3–5 ADS moves toward domestic enforcement in major markets.

NHTSA, 2026-09-30 · InsideGlobalTech, 2026-10-01

Quality SDV

Jaguar Land Rover expands DC-DC converter software recall in the US

NHTSA recall 26V600000, filed 18 September 2026, expands JLR's prior 26V248 campaign covering DC-DC converter failure that can cause complete loss of drive power. Dealers will update vehicle software free of charge, with interim owner letters due 13 November 2026.

So what — Second expansion in six months shows software remediation of a safety-critical power defect across the JLR fleet.

NHTSA Recalls Database, 2026-09-28

● Robotics and autonomous vehicles

AI Regulatory Telematics services

Toray and T2 start commercial autonomous-truck freight on Japanese highways

Toray Industries and autonomous-trucking company T2 began commercial operations carrying petrochemical freight on Japanese expressways, announced via PR Times on 3 October. The deployment is among the first revenue-generating Level-4-adjacent autonomous freight missions in Japan.

So what — First paid autonomous freight route for a major Japanese industrial shipper, advancing driver-shortage mitigation.

PR Times, 2026-10-03

Quality Regulatory AI

Agility Robotics and FORT Robotics sign MOU on Digit 5 humanoid safety architecture

On 1 October, Agility Robotics and FORT Robotics signed an MOU embedding a three-part safety architecture — safety pendant, on-robot communications, and an Offboard Safety Bridge — into Digit 5, expanding FORT's role into joint hardware development and regulatory compliance.

So what — Sets a reference safety stack for scaled humanoid deployment in warehouses and manufacturing.

Investing News / company release, 2026-10-01 · The AI Insider, 2026-10-01

Telematics services AI Data mgmt

ANYbotics launches Shift fleet platform for ANYmal quadrupeds

On 1 October ANYbotics launched Shift, a fleet-operations platform integrating plant mapping, robot coordination, inspection AI and third-party systems for ANYmal quadrupeds. Shift AI converts field findings directly into maintenance work orders for oil-and-gas and industrial inspection customers.

So what — Robotics OEMs are now selling telematics-style fleet management, mirroring vehicle TSP offerings.

The Robot Report, 2026-10-01

● Fleets

Connectivity Cybersecurity SDV

Kigen automotive eSIM is first certified to GSMA eSA for SGP.32 v1.3

Arm Kigen achieved GSMA eUICC Security Assurance certification for its automotive eSIM supporting SGP.32 v1.3, including direct and indirect profile downloads and emergency profile handling. Hybrid post-quantum cryptography is included and ETSI MFF2 sampling begins October 2026.

So what — Sets the first security benchmark for the IoT eSIM standard likely to replace SGP.22 in long-life vehicles.

Media OutReach Newswire, 2026-09-29

Regulatory Data mgmt

EU Data Act design obligations for connected vehicles apply from 12 September

From 12 September 2026, EU Data Act design obligations require connected products including fleet vehicles to enable user-directed data access. Fleet owners can nominate third-party data recipients without going through the manufacturer, covering raw and pre-processed sensor and usage data.

So what — Shifts control of in-vehicle data from OEMs to fleet operators across the EU single market.

Automotive IQ, 2026-09-30

Telematics services Data mgmt

OCTO Telematics and TruckerCloud partner on US commercial auto insurance telematics

On 28 September OCTO and TruckerCloud announced a partnership combining OCTO's DriveAbility risk scoring and crash-detection hardware for Class 1–6 vehicles with TruckerCloud's normalisation platform spanning around 200 ELD, camera and telematics systems. The joint offer targets US commercial insurers.

So what — Consolidates fragmented commercial-fleet telematics data into a single insurer-grade feed.

OCTO Telematics newsroom, 2026-09-28

● Energy

AI Quality Data mgmt

NVIDIA launches DSX Ready BESS qualification; Tesla, LG and Hitachi first approved

NVIDIA launched its DSX Ready qualification programme for AI data-centre power and cooling on 24 September.

So what — Turns utility-scale storage into a specified component of AI factory reference designs.

NVIDIA Newsroom, 2026-09-24 · Hitachi Energy Newsroom, 2026-09-24

Connectivity Telematics services

Humax launches 22 kW fleet EV charger with built-in 4G eSIM

Humax EV Charging unveiled the MX PRO 22 kW fleet charger at Fleet & Mobility Live on 6–7 October. It includes a built-in 4G eSIM allowing network changes without SIM swaps, supports OCPP 1.6J, and is field-upgradeable to OCPP 2.0.1.

So what — Embeds orchestrated connectivity into charge-point hardware, following the vehicle eSIM model.

FleetPoint, 2026-10-05

Regulatory Connectivity

California signs VPP and balcony solar bills, vetoes community solar

Governor Gavin Newsom signed bills supporting virtual power plants and balcony solar whilst vetoing a community solar bill, processing around 1,200 energy measures. The VPP legislation aims to accelerate aggregation of distributed storage and EV charging as controllable grid resources.

So what — Clarifies US legal basis for aggregating EVs and home storage into dispatchable grid assets.

Energy-Storage.News, 2026-10-02

● Agri and industrial OEMs

AI SDV Digital twins

Applied Intuition partners with Komatsu on next-generation autonomous mining haulage

Applied Intuition confirmed a partnership with Komatsu to co-develop the next-generation autonomous haulage system, bringing its vehicle-intelligence software to Komatsu's mining fleet. The collaboration extends Applied Intuition's automotive SDV autonomy stack into off-highway equipment.

So what — Automotive autonomy vendors are moving into mining, blurring on- and off-highway software stacks.

Applied Intuition blog, 2026-09-01

Regulatory Cybersecurity

EU Cyber Resilience Act Article 14 reporting duties go live for off-highway machinery

From 11 September 2026, CRA Article 14 requires manufacturers of connected products — including agricultural vehicles, non-road mobile machinery, and retrofit telematics — to report actively exploited vulnerabilities within 24 hours to ENISA and national CSIRTs.

So what — Creates a parallel cybersecurity regime for off-highway OEMs outside UN R155.

Agnile / CRA Evidence, 2026-09-11

● Deals and partnerships logged this week

Who	With	What	Domain	Relevance
Toray Industries	T2	Commercial autonomous-truck freight contract	Robotics / AV	Prospect
Applied Intuition	Komatsu	Co-development of autonomous haulage system	Agri / industrial	Partner
Agility Robotics	FORT Robotics	Safety architecture MOU for Digit 5 humanoid	Robotics / AV	Partner
OCTO Telematics	TruckerCloud	Strategic partnership on US commercial insurance telematics	Fleets	Competitive

Watch list

ACTIA shows HPC-centric SDV platform for trucks and buses at IAA Transportation. Signals centralised compute reaching commercial-vehicle platforms, lagging passenger cars by about two years.

Voltback raises €2.8m to scale connected-vehicle EV reimbursement platform. Shows demand for software-only fleet services built on OEM telematics feeds under the EU Data Act.

Hyundai recalls 96,000 Tucson vehicles for instrument panel software defect. Confirms OTA as the default remedy for infotainment and cluster software defects at scale.

Woven by Toyota details seven-stage AV data pipeline for end-to-end model training. Rare visibility into a Japanese OEM's AV data pipeline as E2E models become the dominant approach.

Deere FTC right-to-repair settlement reopens aftermarket to independent shops. Weakens OEM lock-in on diagnostics and parts data across US agricultural and construction fleets.

Geotab launches telematics-linked fleet fuel card to curb unauthorised spend. Extends telematics platforms into payment orchestration, converging fuel cards with fleet data.

Method: 75 candidates screened across ~60 sources for the week; items scored 0–10 on significance, novelty and relevance; threshold 6. Themes: SDV, connectivity, AI, data management, digital twins, regulatory framework, cybersecurity, quality and telematics services. Full source list in editions/ on GitHub.